

How to Get Paid in the Agentic AI Era — Aasan Summary (Roman Urdu + English)

Source: *The AI Agent Factory* — “Getting Paid as a Vertical FDE” (Panaversity)

🌀 Bunyadi Idea

Yeh page poori business series ka **capstone** hai — matlab: “Book ne jo sikhaya, woh paise mein kaise badalta hai?”

2 cheezein aik sath ho rahi hain: 1. **Developers ko kaam nahi mil raha** — agents routine code likh rahe hain, junior roles kam ho rahi hain, freelance boards bhare pade hain 2. **Companies AI se paisa nahi bana pa rahin** — tqreeban 95% enterprise AI pilots koi measurable return nahi dete, kyunki koi AI ko company ke real kaam mein **fit** nahi karta

Dono sentences ko saath rakho: ek taraf capable log hain jinke paas rasta nahi, dusri taraf paisa hai jo use nahi ho raha. Beech ka faasla iska naam hai: **Deployment Gap**. Yeh gap exactly **ek job ke barabar** hai.

3 tareeqay paisa kamane ke: Job, Freelance/Retainer, ya apna Startup.

🏢 Market Ka Jawab: Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE)

FDE normal software engineer se ulta kaam karta hai — head office mein product banane ki bajaye, **customer ki company ke andar jaake**, unke real data par, jab tak real value na mile, wahin kaam karta hai.

Demand ke numbers: - FDE job postings 9 mahine mein **800%+ barh gayin**, jabke candidates sirf ~50% barhe - 2026 mein ek hafte mein AWS aur Microsoft ne mil kar **\$3.5 billion** naye FDE units par lagaye - OpenAI ne ek poori deployment company banai isi role ke liye

Yaad rahe: Yeh bare numbers **enterprise buying** ke hain (Unilever, Novo Nordisk jaisi companies). Aapka **pehla customer** aik chota, 20-200 logon wala firm hoga jahan sirf ek partner faisla karta hai.

🔒 Do Bande Darwaze Jo Market Band Rakhta Hai

1. **Lock-in (client ko nuksaan)** — Har vendor ka FDE apne hi platform mein sab kuch jorta hai. Client permanently us platform mein phans jata hai.
2. **Hiring Door (aapko nuksaan)** — Vendor FDE role **senior door** hai: 5+ saal ka experience, aksar US/Europe ka address chahiye. Duniya ke zyada tar developers is se bahar hain.

Dono ki ek hi wajah: Vendor ka platform hi woh cheez hai jo deploy ho rahi hai, aur vendor hi decide karta hai kaun isay use kar sakta hai.

☛ Hamara Jawab: Vendor-Neutral Vertical FDE

2 lafz, har lafz ek problem theek karta hai:

- **Vendor-Neutral** → Lock-in theek karta hai. Aap kisi platform se bandhay nahi hote. Behtar model aaye to client shift kar sakta hai. **Client “freedom” ke liye pay karta hai.**
- **Vertical** → Khali-haathon wali problem theek karta hai. Vendor ka engineer platform le kar aata hai. Platform hata do, to specialization kahin to lag’ni chahiye — **aik profession** par lagti hai.

Aap 2 Systems of Record leke jate hain client ke darwaze tak: 1. **Shared Method** — poori book, har graduate ko milta hai (Agent Factory System of Record) 2. **Aik Profession** — sirf aapka, aik expert ke sath bana hua

Ownership Argument: Model, runtime, aapke ghante, ya vendor ka platform — koi bhi cheez aap **own** nahi kar sakte (rented, replaced, ya shared hoti hain). Sirf ek cheez survive karti hai: **ek profession ki governed knowledge, ek jurisdiction mein, ek committed expert ke sath.**

🔧 Technology Kahan Sikhein?

Yeh page sirf **paisa** sikhata hai, technology nahi. Technology ke liye **Getting Started: Crash Courses** hai.

- Sab ek jaise **6 Foundation courses** se shuru karte hain
 - Phir 1 faisla: **Mode 1** (AI se apna kaam karo) ya **Mode 2** (AI banao jo kaam kare)
 - Yeh road **Mode 2** maangta hai — kyunki aap “manufactured Workers” bechte hain, apni speed nahi
 - **~15 ghante** → pehla Digital FTE ship ho jata hai
 - **~28 ghante** → poori governed workforce, evaluations ke sath
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⚠ Pehle Kya Expect Karo, Kya Check Karo

Zyada tar log Service Ladder par kamayenge — client ke liye SoR banao aur Workers manufacture karo, koi expert ya vertical zaroori nahi. Yeh **hafton ya mahinon mein** pay karta hai.

Vertical business rare outcome hai — sirf usko milta hai jisay ek **committed expert** milay.

5 Sawal (Station 5 se pehle likh kar jawab do)

#	Sawal	Kyun Zaroori
1	Kya aap ek senior practitioner ka naam le sakte hain jo aaj aapki call le?	Poora vertical isi ek insaan ke “haan” par khada hai Statutes publish kar

2	Kya aapki vertical public law se governed hai, licensed standards se nahi?	sakte hain, commercial standards ki permission mushkil hoti hai
3	Kya aap 6-9 mahine fund kar sakte hain?	“Build first, sell second”
4	Kya aapki jurisdiction ke rules English mein achi tarah documented nahi hain?	Jahan model pehle se jawab de sakta hai, wahan aapka corpus bekaar hai
5	Kya aap legally cross-border payment le sakte hain?	Jo invoice na ho, woh income nahi

5 “**haan**”: Vertical ladder khula hai. **Sawal 1 ya 2 par “nahi**”: Service ladder par kamao, expert dhoondte raho.

9 Stations Ka Roadmap

Pehle 4: Padhna (aur faisla). Agle 4: Banana (aik asset). Aakhri: Bechna.

#	Station	Aap Kya Leke Jaate Hain
1	Roles samjho	Pata chalta hai konsi seat aapko fit karti hai
2	Ecosystem samjho	Trio pattern (SoR + Twin + Builder), apna agent SoR se connect karo
3	FDE AF Model samjho	5 layers, promotion law, earning map
4	Kya own kar sakte ho, samjho	2 SoR ka concept + “build first, sell second” ka rule
5	Apni vertical choose karo	Validated vertical + signed expert, ya honest exit
6	Vertical SoR design karo	6 filled templates + ek designed thin slice
7	SoR Framework par banao	Slice live — website (insaan ke liye) + MCP (agents ke liye)
8	System of Context jorho	Connection pattern — authority map, packet shape, connector patterns
9	Kaam par jao	Income + pehla real baseline number

Station 5 — Solo Builder Ke Liye 2 Tips

- **Public law ko licensed standards se behtar samjho** (asaan publish, permission ka jhagra nahi)

- **Wo jurisdiction choose karo jahan rules kam documented hain** — wahan aapki corpus qeemti hai

Station 8 — Zaroori Farq

- **System of Record** = kya sach hai
- **System of Context** = kya customer ke real kaam mein pahunchta hai
- **Layer 3** (pattern) = aapka asset, har client ke liye reusable
- **Layer 4** (fitting) = har client ke andar ka kaam, jiska aap paisa lete ho

📌 Station 9 Ke Baad — Teen Darwaze

Darwaza	Kya	Fayda
1. Job	Résumé mein aik governed slice — jo kisi screener ne pehle nahi dekha	Exit: client aapko FDE rent kar sakta hai, phir permanently hire!
2. Freelance	Marketplace category exist karta hai, lekin generalists se bhara hai	Koi border nahi — Karachi se, Lagos se, sab jagah se kaam mil sakta hai
3. Startup	Apna vertical, expert ke sath co-own	Compounding — har engagement vertical ko motta banata hai

Common path: Freelance kaam build ko fund karta hai → pehla proven result aapko hireable banata hai → thickening vertical startup ban jata hai. Teenon milkar chalte hain.

💰 Har Darwaza Kya Deta Hai (Real Numbers)

Darwaza	Kya Milta Hai
Job	Median ~\$190,000/saal, typical \$170K-\$200K+, Anthropic ke bands \$200K-\$300K, senior \$450K-\$600K
Freelance (project)	Pehla integration: \$2,000-\$5,000, custom: \$5,000-\$15,000, enterprise: \$15,000+
Freelance (per ghanta)	Strategic consulting: \$150-\$250/ghanta, UK day rates £600-£2,000
Retainer	Har mahine \$4,000-\$10,000 (recurring, compound hone wala)
Startup	Koi fixed band nahi — 4 layers par kamata hai, aap khud price set karte ho

Yaad rahe: Yeh aapka pehla number nahi hai! Pehla paid kaam usually **chota** hota hai — kuch sau se kuch hazar dollar. Yeh **service ladder** apna kaam kar rahi hai — normal baat hai.

🔪 Kaam Ki Pricing Kaise Karein

Ghante bechna band karo. Result becho.

Contract of Success — 3 numbers likhit shakal mein: 1.

Baseline — abhi kaam kaisa hota hai (buyer se hi milega, aap pehle se nahi jaan sakte) 2. **Target** — success kya hoga 3. **Acceptance**

Criteria — reviewer kaise check karega

Example: “1 file mein 4 ghante lagte the → ab 40 minute” — yeh price ka bunyad hai.

Retainer = aapke ghante nahi, **Workers ko operate/improve karne ki fee. Products** (Layer 3) = expert twin subscriptions, domain education, ready-made Workers — kabhi bhi hourly billed nahi.

⚠ **Warning:** Result ke liye charge karna matlab, agar result na mile to uska cost bhi aap uthate hain. Sirf tab price karo jab checker/evaluation real ho.

🪜 Raste Mein Bhi Kamao (Service Ladder)

Vertical ladder **compound hoti hai baad mein**. Service ladder **abhi kamati hai**: - **Layer 1** — client ke manuals/procedures ko SoR mein load karo, governance set karo, build+upkeep charge karo - **Layer 2/4** — deployed tools se Workers manufacture karo, client outcome ke liye pay karta hai

Dono ke liye **koi vertical/expert zaroori nahi**. Aur yeh aapko practitioners se milaata hai — usually yahin se aapko apna expert milta hai!

🗺 Rasta Kitna Lamba Hai (Planning Shape)

Stations	Kaam	Waqt
1-4	Padhna aur faisla	1-2 hafte
Crash courses	Building sikhna	~15 ghante (pehla FTE), ~28 (governed workforce)
5	Screening, tests, 4 gates	60-90 din
6	Archaeology, slice design	3-6 hafte
7	Slice banana	2-4 hafte
8	System of Context tayyar karo	1-2 hafte
9	Pehla sponsor, pehla close	1-3 mahine

2 baatein: Stations overlap hote hain (calendar rows ka total nahi). 2 rows aapke control mein nahi — expert ka “haan” aur buyer ka time.

✖ 8 Failure Modes

1. **Résumé polish karna, slice nahi banana** — sabse natural galti. Slice hi credential hai
2. **Bina signed expert ke launch karna** — “usne principle mein maan liya” kaafi nahi
3. **Sab se bara market choose karna, aasan sale nahi** — healthcare/banking sabse slow bikta hai
4. **Slice ko demo ki tarah ship karna** — ugly cases/exceptions shamil nahi kiye
5. **Staff augmentation ko engagement samajhna** — “hum understaffed hain” = sirf ghante rent karna
6. **Vertical ko wide karna taake bara lage** — profession ka shape shared method hai, corpus khali reh jata hai
7. **Bina expert ke force karna** — sabar rakho, service ladder se kamao, expert khud mil jayega
8. **Connection layer pehle banana, jab kuch connect karne ko na ho** — pehle slice ship karo

Yeh failure nahi: Poora method chalao aur sirf **service domain** par ruk jao, vertical na banao — yeh **sahi outcome** hai, zyada tar readers ke liye expected!

‡ Ayesha Ki Kahani (Ek Example)

Ayesha graduate hoti hai, roles samajhti hai, ecosystem use karti hai, model samajhti hai. Uski **aunt** (20 saal ki accountant) uska expert ban'ti hai. “Audit working-paper preparation” uski vertical ban'ti hai. Woh **customer support** ko apna service domain banati hai jo raste mein bills pay karta hai.

Zaroori sabak: Uska pehla buyer Chicago mein hai, expert Pakistan mein. **Border cross karna = naya build**, na ke free extension — nayi jurisdiction ke liye naya expert sign-off chahiye. Usne isay ek “repeat with its own cost” ki tarah price kiya — isi liye sale kaam kar gayi!

Result: 6 hafton baad, Worker ek record cite karta hai, ek 2023 ka lease memo alag se attach karta hai, dono mein disagreement report karta hai, aur partner ko escalate karta hai — jo 3 saal purani ek galti pakarta hai! File 4 ghante se 40 minute ban jati hai. Engagement retainer banta hai, retainer unki startup ki pehli revenue banta hai.

✓ “Ready” Ki Definition (Checklist)

- ☐ FDE role, demand, aur lock-in problem apne alfaz mein samjha sakte ho
 - ☐ Getting Started route par chal kar Mode 2 choose kiya
 - ☐ Kam se kam ek horizontal capstone ship kiya (Worker/plugin/connector)
 - ☐ Service ladder par kama rahe ho ya kamane ke liye ready ho
 - ☐ Vertical screen aur 8 tests pass kar chuki hai, ya honestly parked hai
 - ☐ Expert **signed** hai (sirf “agreed in principle” nahi)
 - ☐ Har source ka rights basis documented hai
 - ☐ Thin slice complete hai — outcome contract, invariants, reflex, checker, evaluation set
 - ☐ Slice kernel par live hai — website + MCP dono
 - ☐ Pata hai kis customer ko System of Context chahiye
 - ☐ Portfolio page slice se shuru hoti hai, har point outcome batata hai, activity nahi
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✦ Honest Label — Kya Measured Hai, Kya Sirf Reasoning

Measured (real evidence): FDE demand, pay bands, \$ billion units, enterprise pilot failure rate.

Not measured (sirf reasoning): Ke “governed slice → pehla client” — category naya hai, koi verified count nahi. Safer claim: **bina slice ke, aap meeting to le sakte ho, lekin number leke nahi aayenge.**

Pay table forecast nahi hai — jo employers post karte hain, jo marketplaces advertise karte hain. Aapka apna pehla number aapke pehle buyer ke sath discover hoga.

📖 Quick Glossary

Term	Aasan Matlab
FDE	Engineer jo client ki company ke andar embed hota hai jab tak outcome prove na ho
Vendor-neutral	Kisi ek AI company ke platform se bandha hua nahi
Vertical	Ek profession, ek country mein (jaise “Pakistan mein tax practice”)
System of Record	Governed truth source — website (insaan ke liye) + MCP (agent ke liye)
System of Context	Layer jo records ko customer ke real kaam se jorta hai
Slice	Ek professional outcome, पूरी तरह cover kiya hua
Service Ladder	Shared method se kamana — koi vertical zaroori nahi
Vertical Ladder	Apni vertical se kamana — expert twin, products, engagements
Contract of Success	Baseline + Target + Acceptance Criteria, likhit

Yeh summary poore “How to Get Paid in the Agentic AI Era” page ka overview hai. Yeh Loop Engineering, Harness Engineering, aur Ecosystem chapters ke baad, “yeh sab seekh kar paisa kaise banayein” ka jawab hai.